Yet, the question of what young Pakistanis want as a system of governance is not a simple one to answer. 'Polling in recent years finds that nearly two-thirds of young Pakistanis favour an Islamic state; more than 80% are at least moderately religious; and a full third support Sharia-style punishments such as floggings and the severing of limbs. Overwhelming numbers identify themselves as Muslims rather than as Pakistanis' (Kugelman 2012, p. 4). Yet, what is meant by an 'Islamic rule' remains unclear. Such sentiments are not restricted to the poorer, less educated classes. However, a more in-depth analysis of Pakistani society, in particular young Pakistanis, reveals how Pakistan's religious fault lines are as stark as the ethnic ones. The Islamic revolution promised by Munawar Hassan's Jamaat-e-Islami (JI) party has not brought in support at the polls, and Islamic rule such as that of Maulvi Fazlullah, who ruled Swat when that region was subjected to Sharia law, was characterized by the kind of brutality that has cost him public support.

Yet, BC research has shown that democracy does not seem to be the system of choice for many – 38 per cent expressed a preference for Islamic rule and 32 per cent would opt for military rule, while only 29 per cent thought that democracy was the best system for Pakistan (BC NGBB[53] Data Pack National, slide 24). While disillusionment with the last five years certainly played a part in these opinions, one could also argue that the lack of understanding as to how the system works is largely at fault. It is important to see what the youth has to say about democracy, 'Islamic rule' and the role of the army in Pakistani politics.

In the discussion that follows, young Pakistanis express their lack of faith in state institutions and a functioning democracy, with most having no understanding of the social contract. However, many do trust the army, not only for providing security but also for dispensing justice through military courts. In a country where young people lack confidence in state institutions, the future of democracy is in question.

The army continues to occupy a position of reverence for the majority of young Pakistanis in this study. Across all groups most, although not all, seemed to think that the army was a key player in the Pakistani system and the most visible and able part of the state apparatus:

> *'[The] army is everything here. The link between state and army is so vague. Foreign policy is run by the army'; 'Army is the only stable institution we have'; 'With bureaucrats there is a bond between them and the army. Come on – in every family one brother is in the army and the other in the bureaucracy. That is how it works.'*
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> (Focus Group, Private University[54])